MEGHNA AGARWAL, 48
Co-founder, IndiQube
Bengaluru

The Space Maker



ANIRUDDH KAUSHAL

WHAT MAKES HER A SHERO

With no prior experience in real estate, Meghna co-founded a flexible workspaces company that now manages 10 million square feet of office space across India and which she took public in 2025

Meghna Agarwal became an entrepreneur 'by accident'. Growing up in Alwar, Rajasthan, she prepared herself for a career by securing an MBA and company secretaryship. "I think it was the fear of ending up in a kitchen or as part of the *saas-bahu* saga which kind of pushed me to work really hard," she says. But a bleak job market following the 9/11 attacks proved to be a fortuitous turning point. In late 2003, at age 25, Agarwal co-founded the recruitment platform, HirePro Consulting, a month after she got married to Rishi Das, founder of Careernet.

Equally serendipitous is the story of how she co-founded IndiQube in 2015 as a company providing flexible workspaces. Both Agarwal and Das ran their ventures out of the same building along Bengaluru's Outer Ring Road tech corridor, leasing out excess space to a few startups. Eventually, when Agarwal wanted more room for her firm, the lessees, reluctant to move, persuaded her to replicate the same co-working set-up for them elsewhere. She took over a 150,000 square feet building across the road which, to her surprise, filled up in a matter of months. That's when Agarwal, with no prior real estate experience, saw an opportunity in the market for plug-and-play, flexible work spaces.

Today, IndiQube manages 10.61 million square feet of office space in 17 cities as an integrated managed spaces platform, with Fortune 500 firms as its clients. "Our stand, that flexibility was the key, got vindicated," says Agarwal, who took IndiQube public in 2025. In FY26, the company's revenue grew 37 per cent to Rs 1,469 crore.

Her vision for the firm: "The idea is to venture out to other branches like retail and hospitality. Anything to do with space." The secret sauce for making the idea work, says the mother of two, is frugality. "Frugality means you are cost-conscious about everything," she adds. "There's a difference between being cheap and being frugal. I'm not talking about cheap but about being efficient." ■

— Ajay Sukumaran

WOMAN TO WOMAN

"I believe in 4 Cs. You need to have Clarity on what you want to do. Second is Control; women have to take control of their own lives. Third is Communication, and fourth is Consistency, because as a woman, especially, you will have phases in your life due to marriage, kids and ageing parents when you will be pushed to pause or slow down"